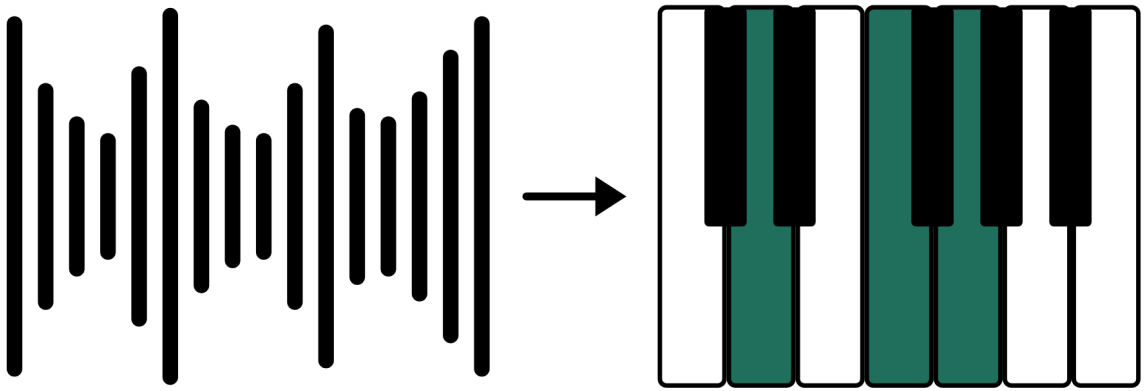
HUDSON BEAT



FOUND SOUND

Turn everyday sounds into instruments.

LISTEN: NAME THAT SOUND

WHAT WAS THAT?

Guess, then explain how you know

Teacher: make a short everyday sound out of view (a zip, a drawer, a pen click).

- What do you think made it?
- What does it remind you of?
- Could it be a drum, a bass or a pad?

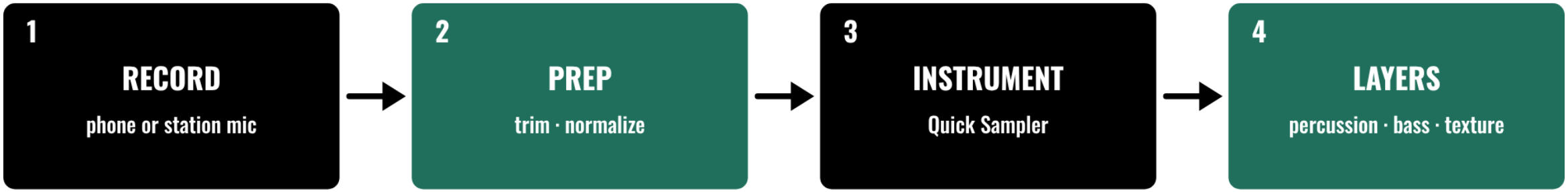
WHAT IS FOUND SOUND?

- Any real-world sound used as raw material for music
- Quick Sampler turns any audio into a playable instrument
- Sound design: shaping sounds for a purpose

SEVEN CLASSES

CLASS 1	Name that sound · found sound · sound to song · live demo
CLASS 2	Classic · One Shot · Slice · demo · go weird
CLASS 3	Working day: compose and layer
CLASS 4	Working day: the worked example, check your layers
CLASS 5	Working day: compose, layer, mix
CLASS 6	Mix · bounce · checklist · rubric
CLASS 7	Presentations with Padlet Q&A

FROM SOUND TO SONG



A sound is only raw material until you turn it into an instrument and layer it

- Record clean sounds
- Trim and normalize them
- Build instruments in Quick Sampler
- Layer them into a piece

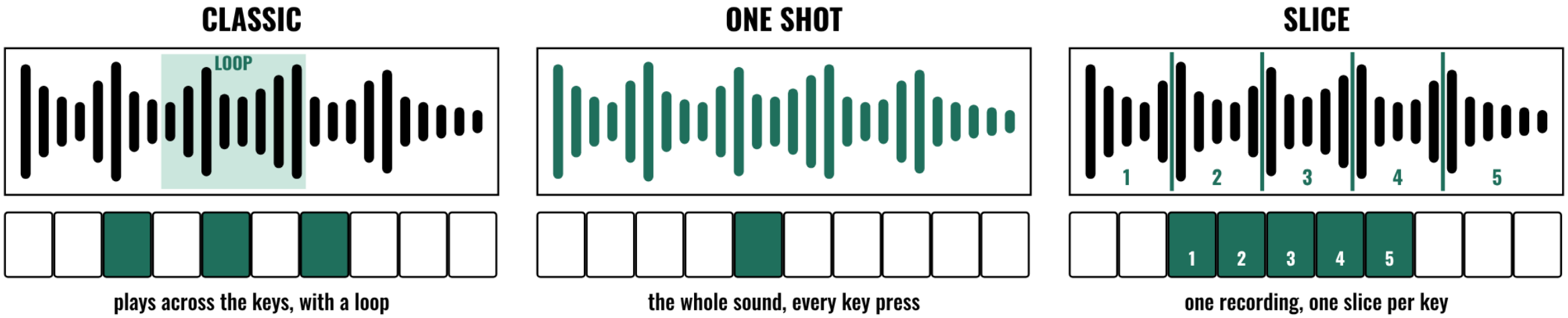
WATCH ME: SOUND TO INSTRUMENT

1. Record one short everyday sound
2. Trim it and normalize it in Logic
3. Drag it into Quick Sampler
4. Play it on the keyboard
5. Name it and save the project

STEPS 1 AND 2: COLLECT, PREP

1. Record at least 5 sounds
2. Use your phone or the microphone at your station
3. Get clean recordings: close, quiet, no wind
4. Trim, normalize and clean up in Logic
5. Fill in the Sound log

THREE QUICK SAMPLER MODES



- Classic: across the keys, with a loop
- Slice: one recording, a whole kit
- One Shot: the whole sound each time
- Pick the mode that fits the job

WATCH ME: ALL THREE MODES

1. Take one recording with several hits
2. Play it in Classic, with a loop
3. Switch to One Shot
4. Switch to Slice and play the kit
5. Which mode fits which job?

GO WEIRD

- The weirder the source, the better the instrument
- Don't just record the obvious
- Try Slice on one recording
- Transformation is the goal

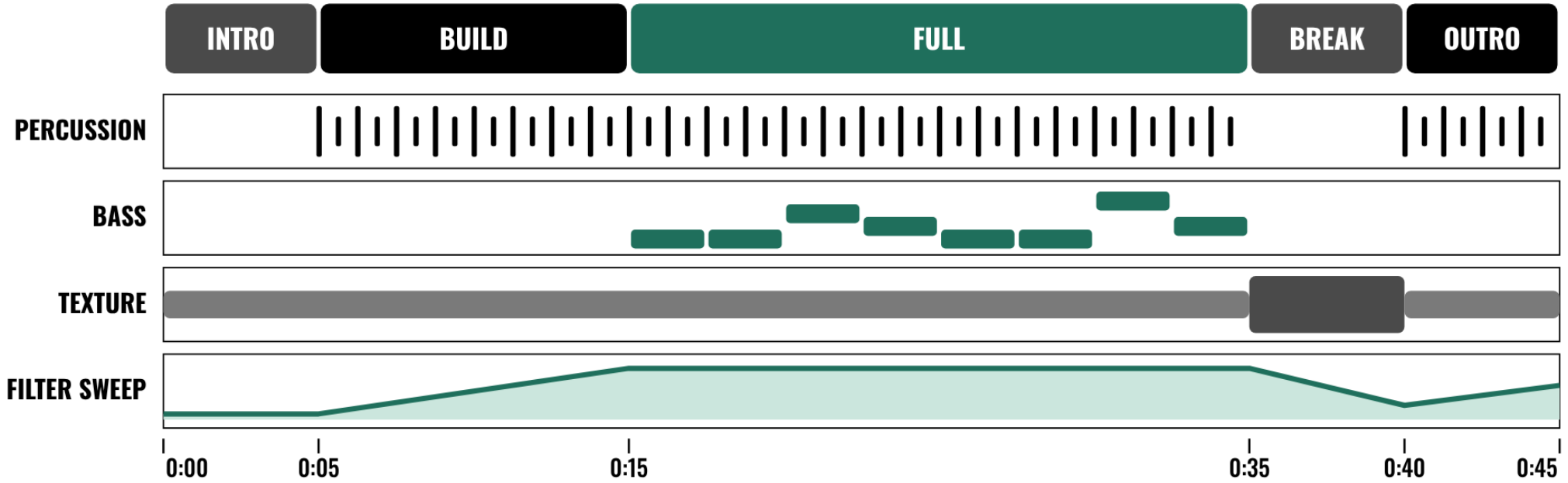
WORKING DAYS: COMPOSE

- Use your custom instruments to build the piece
- Stop auditioning, start playing
- Aim for at least 3 layers
- Save versions as you go

THREE LAYERS, NOT ONE

- Percussion · bass · texture
- A single found sound as a melody is thin
- Stack textures underneath
- Density matters more than length

WORKED EXAMPLE: 45 SECONDS ON PAPER



- Three layers, all playing at once
- A filter sweep keeps it moving
- Texture, then percussion, then bass
- Plan 30–60 seconds

CHECK YOUR LAYERS

- Can you name the sound behind each layer?
- Do you have at least 3 layers at once?
- Does something change every few bars?
- Would a stranger guess the source?

STEPS 5 AND 6: MIX, FINALIZE

1. Apply EQ, effects and automation
2. Balance levels and add polish
3. Bounce your track
4. Prepare your presentation

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Found Sound
- [ ] At least 5 source sounds used
- [ ] Padlet post with your 3 questions
- [ ] Answer 2 questions on classmates' posts

HOW IT'S SCORED

CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	5 = Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems	/ 5
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	5 = Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc	/ 5
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	5 = Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery	/ 5

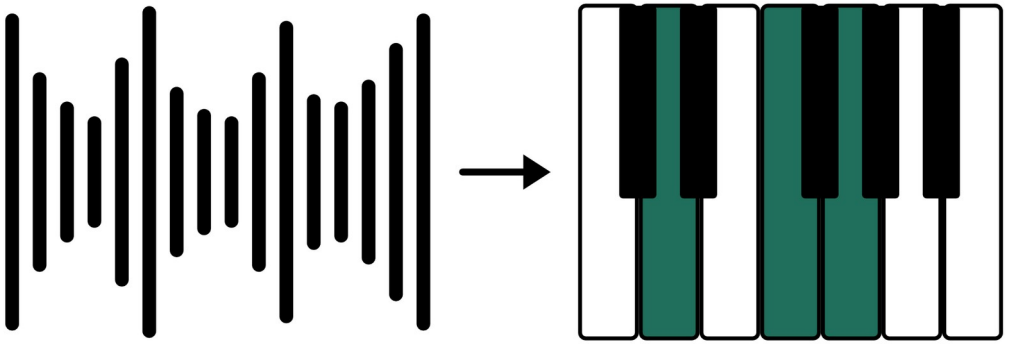
SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25

PRESENTATION DAY

- Play your piece
- Name the sounds you started with
- Your Padlet post: 3 questions about your project
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s 3

ONE LAST THING...

- You listened closely.
- You recorded the world.
- You built instruments from it.
- Now it plays.



REFLECTION · PAGE 21

Write it or talk it through: what went well, what was hard, what you would change.